VISUAL REFERENCE GALLERY · 30 PIECES

Sculptural & Ergonomic Wood Furniture

Laminated veneer, steam-bent strip, molded plywood, CNC-sculpted sections and studio-carved masters.

TECHNIQUE KEY

- Laminated & Bent Veneer
- Steam-Bent Strip
- Molded Plywood
- CNC-Sculpted / Sectional
- Studio Craft Masters

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Sculptural & Ergonomic Wood Furniture

01 LAMINATED & BENT VENEER

Enignum Chair

Joseph Walsh · Ireland

Thin layers of olive ash or walnut are stripped and reassembled so each layer follows the next; the benchmark for free-form lamination.

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02 LAMINATED & BENT VENEER

Enignum Canopy Bed / Lilium

Joseph Walsh · Ireland

The same laminating method pushed to architectural scale: a canopy bed over six metres tall in olive ash.

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03 LAMINATED & BENT VENEER

Ethereal Lounge Chair

Marc Fish · UK

Laminated sycamore veneers spaced apart as open fins rather than a solid mass, with resin details.

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04 LAMINATED & BENT VENEER

Nautilus Table

Marc Fish · UK

A study in micro stack-lamination, using veneer as the primary raw material for a spiralling form.

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05 LAMINATED & BENT VENEER

Möbius Console

Pierre Renart · France

A ribbon of wood curling over itself without end, inspired by the Möbius strip (2013).

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06 LAMINATED & BENT VENEER

Ruban Chair & Wave Bench

Pierre Renart for Longchamp · 2025

American walnut assembled from ultra-thin bent layers with leather seats; the chair took over ten years to refine.

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07 LAMINATED & BENT VENEER

Escale

Pierre Renart · France

A hammock-like seat of seven hornbeam strips that converge like the fibres of a muscle.

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08 LAMINATED & BENT VENEER

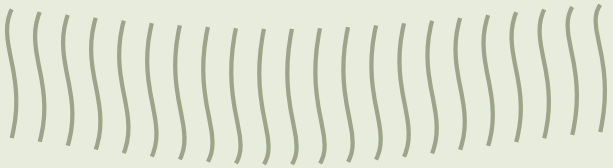
Stack-Laminated Chairs

Wendell Castle · USA

Stacked, glued and carved solid laminations: the historical root of most organic wood seating.

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09 STEAM-BENT STRIP



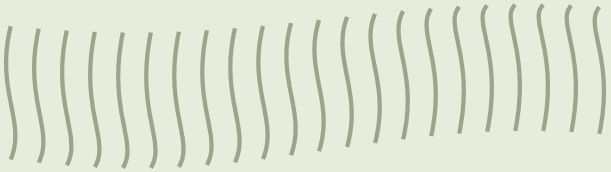
Steam-Bent Benches

Matthias Pliessnig · USA

Ash and white oak strips steam-bent into twisting, CAD-drafted seating surfaces.

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10 STEAM-BENT STRIP



Steam Bent Series

Bae Se Hwa · Korea

Hundreds of walnut strips shaped to the contours of the body; among the most ergonomic pieces here.

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11 STEAM-BENT STRIP



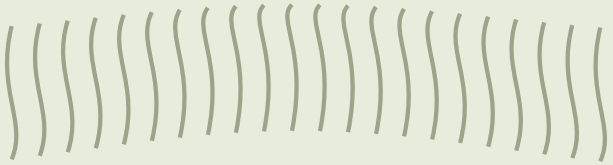
Wooden Chair (1988)

Marc Newson

Steam-bent beech slats coiled into a continuous loop; one repeated element builds the whole volume.

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12 STEAM-BENT STRIP



Bentwood Rocking Chair

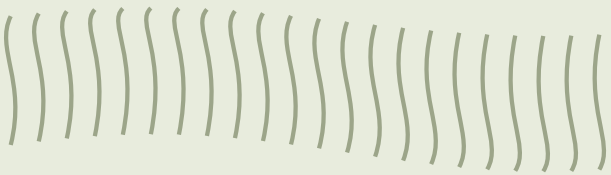
Thonet

The 19th-century origin of solid-wood steam bending: continuous scrolls with minimal joinery.

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Sculptural & Ergonomic Wood Furniture

13 STEAM-BENT STRIP



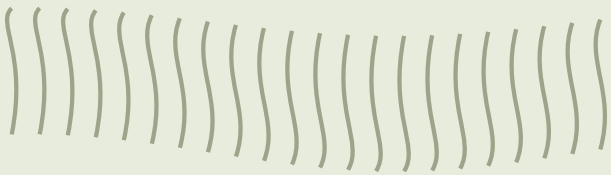
Silva Collection

KFI Studios / Union Design

A production example: solid beech rear legs flow to the backrest in one steam-bent arc.

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14 STEAM-BENT STRIP



Steam-Bent Ribbon Work

Tom Raffield · UK

Looping ash and oak ribbons; the studio's process videos are excellent for learning the technique.

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15 MOLDED PLYWOOD



CH07 Shell Chair

Hans J. Wegner · Carl Hansen

The three-legged 'smiling' molded shell; comfort without upholstery mass.

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16 MOLDED PLYWOOD



Paimio Chair

Alvar Aalto · Artek

Bent birch plywood scroll seat designed for sanatorium patients; ergonomic by brief.

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17 MOLDED PLYWOOD



LCW (Lounge Chair Wood)

Charles & Ray Eames

Separate compound-curve plywood seat and back that follow the body.

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18 MOLDED PLYWOOD



Lounge Chair 670

Charles & Ray Eames

Veneered molded shells in a reclined geometry; still the reference for lounge ergonomics.

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Sculptural & Ergonomic Wood Furniture

19 MOLDED PLYWOOD

Series 7 / Ant Chair

Arne Jacobsen · Fritz Hansen

A single pressed 3D veneer shell with a waist cut-in that gives it flex.

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20 MOLDED PLYWOOD

GJ Chair (1963)

Grete Jalk

Two folded plywood sheets; shows how far developable surfaces can be pushed.

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21 MOLDED PLYWOOD

Osuu Chair

Foster + Partners · Walter Knoll

An all-wood chair combining bentwood and plywood in a light modern production piece.

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22 MOLDED PLYWOOD

Void Lounge Chair

João Teixeira · Teixeira Design Studio

A single sheet of plywood transformed into a sculptural, functional lounge chair.

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23 CNC-SCULPTED / SECTIONAL

Cowrie & Alpha Chairs

Brodie Neill · Made in Ratio

CNC routing used as a production tool so components merge into one seamless mold.

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24 CNC-SCULPTED / SECTIONAL

Vivien Chair

Luca Nichetto · De La Espada

Solid wood machined on CNC, then carved, assembled and finished by hand. A CAD-first workflow.

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Sculptural & Ergonomic Wood Furniture

25 CNC-SCULPTED / SECTIONAL



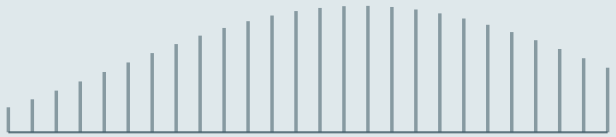
Murena & Möbius Benches

Oleg Soroko

Stacked CNC-cut 18 mm plywood sections reinforced with metal rods; waffle-frame adjacent.

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26 CNC-SCULPTED / SECTIONAL



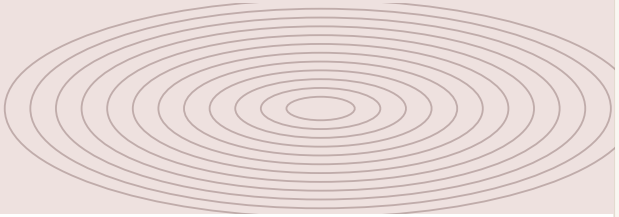
Lolo & Aida Chairs

Piegatto · Guatemala

Sectional contouring from laminated birch plywood slices, done in a production-friendly way.

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27 STUDIO CRAFT MASTERS



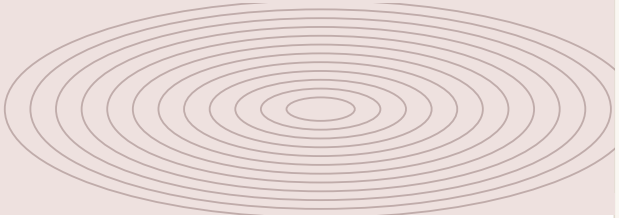
Rocking Chair

Sam Maloof · USA

Sculpted walnut joints flow into one another and the seat is carved to the sitter.

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28 STUDIO CRAFT MASTERS



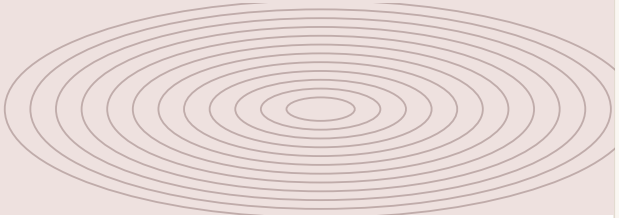
Conoid Chair

George Nakashima · USA

Cantilevered sled base and spindle back; the structure itself is the aesthetic.

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29 STUDIO CRAFT MASTERS



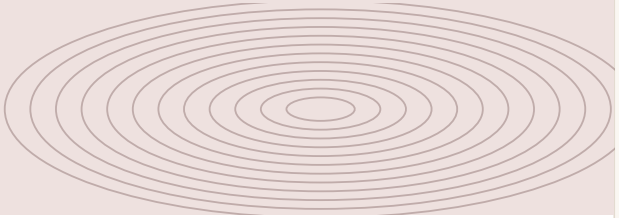
Sculptural Chairs

Wharton Esherick · USA

The American studio-furniture origin of faceted, expressive organic wood forms.

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30 STUDIO CRAFT MASTERS



PK15 Chair

Poul Kjærholm · Fritz Hansen

A quieter, minimalist counterpoint defined by its bent-wood lines.

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Patterns Worth Taking Into Your Own Work

1 Let the grain set the curve

Walsh, Fish and Renart bend thin laminations instead of carving against the grain. The curve is whatever the stacked layers allow, which is why the forms look effortless and stay strong.

2 Start from the body, let structure follow

The most comfortable pieces (Bae Se Hwa, Maloof, Wegner, Aalto) are built from seat and back contours outward; legs and frames are resolved last.

3 Pick the process before the form

Steam-bent strips suit open, slatted surfaces; molded plywood suits shells; stack lamination suits massive, carved volumes. Designing within one process keeps the piece buildable.

4 CAD-first workflows that translate

Nichetto's CNC-then-hand-finish approach and Soroko / Piegatto's sectional builds are the most direct routes from a 3D model to a sculptural wood piece.

5 Repetition creates complexity

Newson, Pliessnig and the sectional benches all use one repeated element — a slat, a strip, a rib — to generate a complex overall volume with simple parts.